

ESSENTIAL

Document Checklist by Applicant Type

Employed - Self-Employed - Student - Hosted - Business

Every applicant needs

- Valid passport meeting the validity and blank-page requirements
- Completed application form and biometric photo
- Travel medical insurance certificate meeting the Schengen minimum
- Detailed itinerary and proof of accommodation for every night
- Financial evidence covering the trip (see the Financial Requirements Overview)

If you're employed

- A letter from your employer confirming your role, salary, and approved leave dates
- Recent pay slips and bank statements

If you're self-employed or run a business

- Business registration documents and recent bank statements

If you're a student

- A current enrolment/study confirmation letter
- If a parent/guardian is funding the trip: their financial evidence and a letter confirming support

If you're being hosted by someone in Germany

VERPFLICHTUNGSERKLÄRUNG, NOT A GENERIC LETTER

Your host needs to obtain a formal Verpflichtungserklärung from their own local Ausländerbehörde in Germany - this is a specific German legal document, not something they draft themselves. See the Cover Letter & Host Templates (Complete tier) for what to prepare alongside it.

If you're travelling for business meetings

- A letter from the German company you're meeting, confirming the business purpose
- A letter from your own employer confirming your role and approved travel